



EDU406

Mid-Term (Solved)

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

Maha Malik

Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices

Q. What is the level of teacher's knowledge and inquiry?

Teachers develop their own knowledge through reflective practice, building an “inquiry stance” that allows them to critically assess and improve their teaching. Reflective practitioners construct their professional skills and knowledge based on their own experiences and assumptions.

Q. Role of frames in critical thinking

Frames help us perceive, understand, and describe complex situations by organizing beliefs, values, and assumptions. They influence how we interpret data and take action, often tacitly shaping our thoughts and decisions. Frames also help in identifying and solving "messy" problems.

Q. Importance of framing in critical thinking

Framing is essential because it determines how problems are named and addressed. It shapes meaning, focuses attention on certain aspects of a situation, and influences decision-making. Making frames explicit improves critical engagement with differing perspectives.

Q. What is constructivism? / Assumptions of constructivism

Constructivism views knowledge as socially constructed through interaction and dialogue. Learning occurs in a social context, often within the Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD). Teachers and learners co-construct meaning, and reflection is central to learning.

Q. Which three attitudes did John Dewey describe about reflective practitioners?

Dewey emphasized:

- ✚ Open-mindedness
- ✚ Whole-heartedness (curiosity)
- ✚ Responsibility

These attitudes support critical reflection and continuous learning.

Q. Benefits of critical thinking

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

Critical thinking:

- ✚ Promotes clear, rational, independent thought
- ✚ Enhances problem-solving and decision-making
- ✚ Encourages reflection on beliefs
- ✚ Increases creativity and effective communication
- ✚ Helps navigate complex global knowledge and uncertainty.

Q. Jo-Hari Window Model

This model helps in understanding interpersonal communication by dividing self-awareness into four areas:

- ✚ Open self (known to self and others)
- ✚ Blind self (known to others, not self)
- ✚ Hidden self (known to self, not others)
- ✚ Unknown self (unknown to both)

It's useful for reflection and personal growth.

Q. Mezirow's Transformational Learning

Mezirow's theory emphasizes changing one's frames of reference through critical reflection. It involves:

- ✚ Disorienting dilemmas
- ✚ Critical assessment of assumptions
- ✚ Exploring new roles
- ✚ Reintegration through new perspectives

Transformative learning leads to personal and professional development.

Q. Define critical thinking

Critical thinking is the ability to analyze, synthesize, evaluate information logically and without bias. It involves:

- ✚ Identifying assumptions
- ✚ Evaluating arguments
- ✚ Drawing reasoned conclusions
- ✚ Being open to different viewpoints.

Q. What should be in the mind of a reflective practitioner while leading and planning?

- ✚ Clear goals and objectives
- ✚ Critical evaluation of previous practices
- ✚ Willingness to adapt
- ✚ A focus on student needs
- ✚ Integration of feedback and reflective insights

Q. John Dewey / How Dewey developed reflective practitioners

Dewey saw reflection as purposeful and systematic inquiry based on real-world problems. He encouraged learning through experience, proposing a 5-phase reflective model:

1. Identify a problem
2. Analyze it
3. Develop hypotheses
4. Test solutions
5. Reflect and adapt.

Q. Personal Practical Theory (PPT)

PPT refers to the personal beliefs and theories teachers develop from experience. These guide classroom practices and decision-making. Reflective practitioners surface and refine these to improve teaching.

Q. Disadvantages of peer observation

- ✚ May cause anxiety or stress
- ✚ Can be perceived as judgmental
- ✚ Limited if not followed by constructive feedback
- ✚ May not reflect actual teaching over time

Q. Critical model of Brookfield

Brookfield proposes using four lenses to uncover assumptions:

- ✚ Autobiography as a learner
- ✚ Students' perspectives
- ✚ Colleagues' perspectives

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

✚ Educational literature

This method fosters deeper critical reflection.

Q. Statistical Analysis

Statistical analysis involves prediction and modeling based on data trends (e.g., time series, cross-sectional, or longitudinal data). In reflective practice, it can be used to inform decisions through evidence-based insights.

Q. Relationship between Reflective Practice and Professionalism

Reflective practice supports teacher professionalism by:

- ✚ Encouraging flexibility, creativity, and responsiveness
- ✚ Supporting both academic and pastoral roles
- ✚ Helping shape school ethos
- ✚ Promoting fairness, responsibility, and continuous development It allows teachers to question pedagogical assumptions, adapt to students' needs, and contribute meaningfully to school life.

Q. Comparison Between Conscious Competence and Incompetence

The Conscious Competence Model outlines four stages:

1. Unconscious Incompetence – unaware of a skill gap
2. Conscious Incompetence – aware of the gap and need to improve
3. Conscious Competence – skilled but requiring effort
4. Unconscious Competence – automatic proficiency

Reflective practitioners use this to monitor their development and identify learning needs.

Q. Bloom's Taxonomy and Critical Thinking

Bloom's taxonomy comprises six levels:

- ✚ Knowledge, Comprehension, Application, Analysis, Synthesis, Evaluation

Higher-order levels (Analysis, Synthesis, Evaluation) align closely with critical thinking by encouraging learners to:

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

-  Identify assumptions
-  Evaluate arguments
-  Reflect on conclusions
-  Generate new solutions.

Q. Driscoll and Teh Framework

The Driscoll and Teh Reflective Model is built around three questions:

1. What? – Describing the experience
2. So what? – Understanding the significance
3. Now what? – Planning future action

This model supports structured reflective writing and is practical for classroom application.

Q. Levels of Reflective Thought

Three levels:

1. **Non-reflective action** – routine, habitual responses.
2. **Reflective action** – conscious analysis of experiences.
3. **Premise reflection** – deep questioning of beliefs, values, and assumptions.

Q. Factors of Brainstorming

Brainstorming encourages idea generation through:

-  Open collaboration
-  Focus on learner readiness
-  Emphasis on practical tools (journals, surveys, observation)
-  Synergistic thinking and problem-solving through group work.

Q. Community of Practice / Reason to Establish in Schools

Community of Practice (CoP): A group sharing expertise, tools, and experiences in a shared domain.

Reasons to establish CoP in schools:

-  Rapid knowledge sharing

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices Mid-Term (Solved)

- ✚ Forum for testing ideas
- ✚ Generates new practices
- ✚ Builds trust and collaboration
- ✚ Reduces mistakes and rework
- ✚ Encourages innovation.

Q. Functions of Mentors

Mentors can take on many roles:

- ✚ Coach: Focus on performance improvement
- ✚ Counselor: Provide emotional support
- ✚ Facilitator/Networker: Help connect with others
- ✚ Guardian: Address emotional needs

Mentoring helps reflective practitioners:

- ✚ Gain confidence
- ✚ Adapt to school culture
- ✚ Build critical thinking
- ✚ Develop autonomy and self-efficacy.

Q. Challenges of Reflection

Some of the key challenges include:

- ✚ RP doesn't happen in isolation; it's shaped by social, institutional, and personal factors.
- ✚ Unwritten rules, school cultures, and biases influence reflection.
- ✚ Theories may focus too much on individual reflection, ignoring broader social dynamics and language limitations.
- ✚ There's a risk of viewing students or peers as "objects" rather than collaborators.

Q. What is Action Research?

Action research is a participatory, practical, and solution-oriented inquiry that teachers engage in to improve their own teaching practices. It involves a cyclical process of:

- ✚ Looking → Thinking → Acting

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices Mid-Term (Solved)

- ✚ Identifying a problem
- ✚ Planning and implementing changes
- ✚ Reflecting on results

Key features:

- ✚ Empirical and systematic
- ✚ Focused on transformation of practice
- ✚ Involves collaboration and critical reflection
- ✚ Can be done individually or collectively.

Q. Guidelines for Practice Development (Teachers, School Managers, Curriculum Developers)

- ✚ Promote collaborative learning and shared leadership
- ✚ Ensure reflection is embedded in daily teaching
- ✚ Develop Professional Development Plans (PDPs)
- ✚ Use evidence-based methods and encourage inquiry
- ✚ Foster inter-professional learning (IPL) for richer educational experiences
- ✚ Balance curriculum design with student-centered teaching.

Q. What is Institutional Culture?

Institutional culture includes:

- ✚ Shared values, traditions, and behaviors within a school
- ✚ Influences how teachers reflect and implement changes
- ✚ May support or hinder reflective practice
- ✚ Reflective practitioners should strive to improve their personal practice even in unsupportive cultures.

Q. Themes of Reflective Teaching

- ✚ Ongoing inquiry into classroom practices
- ✚ Analysis of teaching strategies
- ✚ Collaborative dialogue with peers
- ✚ Developing student-centered approaches
- ✚ Emphasis on teacher autonomy
- ✚ Reflection is used for curriculum development and reform.

Q. Benefits of Greenaway's 3-Stage Model

Greenaway's Plan-Do-Review cycle is:

- ✚ Do: Have an experience
- ✚ Review: Reflect on what happened
- ✚ Plan: Decide how to improve for the next round

Benefits:

- ✚ Simple and easy to apply
- ✚ Rooted in real teaching experience
- ✚ Time-efficient
- ✚ Versatile for various school activities
- ✚ Supports continuous improvement.

Q. Techniques of Critical Thinking

- ✚ Clarify and state points clearly
- ✚ Be accurate, precise, and relevant
- ✚ Identify assumptions
- ✚ Check emotions
- ✚ Empathize
- ✚ Be self-aware and open-minded
- ✚ Think through implications
- ✚ Recognize cultural assumptions
- ✚ Consider other perspectives
- ✚ Be fair and suspend judgment.

Q. What is Critical Theory?

Critical theory focuses on emancipating social practices from domination and misinterpretation. It seeks to:

- ✚ Expose hidden values and biases
- ✚ Analyze inconsistencies between actions and beliefs
- ✚ Empower teachers through reflective and critical inquiry
- ✚ Promote transformation in educational settings.

Q. What are Models of Thinking and Reflection?

They involve three key processes:

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

- ✚ Retrospection – Looking back at experience
- ✚ Self-analysis – Interpreting what happened
- ✚ Learning and change – Applying insights to future practice

Q. What are the levels of reflection that can take place during teaching?

According to Zeichner and Liston (1996), the levels include:

- ✚ Rapid reflection – automatic and immediate
- ✚ Repair – modifying behavior in the moment
- ✚ Review – analyzing an aspect of teaching after the lesson
- ✚ Research – systematic and sustained thinking, data collection
- ✚ Re-theorizing and reformulating – critically examining practice using theory

Q. Define Deductive and Inductive Approach

- ✚ **Induction:** Observing facts and forming a hypothesis (bottom-up logic).
- ✚ **Deduction:** Testing that hypothesis logically (top-down logic)

Q. How do teachers increase their knowledge and understanding as professionals?

Through:

- ✚ Self-observation
- ✚ Self-judgment
- ✚ Self-reaction

Q. What are the advantages of peer observation?

- ✚ Improves teaching quality
- ✚ Enhances self-awareness
- ✚ Identifies good practice
- ✚ Encourages professional dialogue and development
- ✚ Promotes collaboration and networking
- ✚ Provides evidence for promotions

Q. What is a Critical Incident? Give three examples

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

A critical incident is any event (positive or negative) that is vividly remembered due to its emotional or instructional impact.

Examples:

1. A student refusing to engage in an activity
2. A sudden classroom behavior issue
3. A moment of realization (light bulb moment) during teaching

It leads to deeper self-analysis and reflection on one's teaching assumptions

Q. Hegarty's Model

Hegarty's Reflective Framework

- ✚ The framework consists of a template that you can follow to structure your reflective writing in three steps. This encourages you to move beyond basic description about your experience to analyze your actions, learning and emotional reactions and thus examine your practice more critically and from different perspectives
- ✚ Take notice and describe the experience- pay attention and record what happened; What did you do, know, feel, think, need? What decisions were made?

Q. Hatton and Smith Types of Reflection

1. Technical Rationality – Skills and behavior-focused.
2. Reflection-on-Action – Post-event reflection.
3. Reflection-in-Action – Real-time reflection. Also includes:

Q. Greenaway's 3-Stage Model (Explained in Detail)

1. Do – Have the experience
2. Review – Reflect on what happened and what can be learned
3. Plan – Plan for the next experience based on insights

Benefits: Simple, time-efficient, grounded in everyday teaching, useful for continuous improvement.

Q. Murphy Model Components

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

Atkins & Murphy's Model which involves:

1. Awareness of discomfort
2. Description
3. Analysis
4. Evaluation
5. Action planning.

Q. Steps of the Reflection Process

- 
-  Describe
 -  Analyze
 -  Theorize
 -  Act

Q. Brookfield's Concept about Learning

Learning happens when we examine assumptions using:

Four lenses: self, students, colleagues, and theory

It's a continuous, reflective process focused on critical insight rather than solving predefined problems.

Q. Conscious Competence Model

Stages:

1. Unconscious incompetence
2. Conscious incompetence
3. Conscious competence
4. Unconscious competence

Used to assess growth and awareness in skill acquisition.

Q. Constructivism

Knowledge is constructed through interaction and dialogue. Emphasizes social learning, reflection, and building on prior knowledge.

Q. Meta-Competence

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

Higher-order thinking including:

- ✚ Communication
- ✚ Creativity
- ✚ Analysis
- ✚ Self-development
- ✚ Problem-solving.

Q. Level of Reflection

Technical, Practical, and Critical levels; aligned with:

- ✚ Reflection-in-action
- ✚ Reflection-on-action
- ✚ Reflection-for-action.

Q. Difference: Dialogical vs Critical Reflection

- ✚ **Dialogical:** Reflecting through internal conversation; focuses on judgment and goals.
- ✚ **Critical:** Examines social, political, and cultural assumptions, aiming for transformation.

Q. Reflection in Action & Reflection on Action

- ✚ **In Action:** Real-time adjustment during teaching
- ✚ **On Action:** Post-event analysis to understand and improve future practice.

Q. Types of Reframing

1. Identify core beliefs
2. Map supporting beliefs
3. Challenge with opposites
4. Construct a new core belief.

Q. Framing vs Reframing Matrix

- ✚ **Framing:** Defining how a situation is understood
- ✚ **Reframing:** Changing that perspective to discover new meanings or actions.

Q. Key Principles of Reflective Practitioner

- ✚ Self-awareness
- ✚ Critical questioning
- ✚ Theorizing from experience
- ✚ Responsiveness to learners
- ✚ Willingness to change and improve.

Q. Reflective Writing

Involves:

- ✚ First-person narrative
- ✚ Analytical thinking
- ✚ Linking theory and practice
- ✚ Structured format (intro, body, conclusion)
- ✚ Includes evidence and learning outcomes.

Q. Advantages/Benefits of Reflective Writing

- ✚ Deepens understanding
- ✚ Promotes personal growth
- ✚ Links theory and experience
- ✚ Enhances decision-making

Q. Advantages of Reflective Speaking

- ✚ Develops communication skills
- ✚ Encourages spontaneous reflection
- ✚ Useful in collaborative and peer discussions

Q. Benefits of Reflective Thinking

- ✚ Insight into practice
- ✚ Clarifies complex issues
- ✚ Supports professional growth
- ✚ Encourages lifelong learning.

Q. Inductive Action Planning in Reflective Practice

Encourages discovery learning through:

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

✚ Experience → Observation → Concept → Experimentation

Helps tailor planning to actual classroom contexts.

Q. Limitations of Self-Reflection

- ✚ May be too subjective
- ✚ Risk of stagnation without feedback
- ✚ Difficult to challenge deep-seated assumptions alone.

Q. Critical Incident Analysis + Examples

A critical incident is a significant event with emotional/learning impact.

Examples:

1. Student disrespect
2. Failed lesson
3. Surprising student reaction

This prompts reflection and transformation.

Q. Critical Questions Teachers Can Ask Themselves

- ✚ What was I trying to achieve?
- ✚ What went well or poorly?
- ✚ What does theory say?
- ✚ How did students respond?
- ✚ What could I do differently?

Q. What Does “Problem Statement” Mean in Reframing?

It's the initial framing of a situation. Reflective practitioners analyze and redefine this to discover new insights or actions.

Q. Role of Teacher in Classroom

- ✚ Facilitator of learning
- ✚ Monitor and guide
- ✚ Encourage collaboration
- ✚ Address learner diversity

EDU406_Critical Thinking and Reflective Practices
Mid-Term (Solved)

 Reflect and adjust strategies.

Q. Broad Categories of Professional Competence

1. Cognitive (knowledge-based)
2. Functional (task-based)
3. Personal (behavior-based)
4. Ethical/Value-based
5. Meta-competences (higher-order skills).

Q. Attributes of Teachers as Critical Thinkers

-  Question assumptions
-  Open to feedback
-  Problem-solving mindset
-  Analytical
-  Self-aware

Q. Importance of Critical Thinking

-  Enhances classroom decision-making
-  Encourages deeper learning
-  Supports professional development
-  Prepares for diverse learner needs

Q. Three Epistemic Stances

1. Absolute Knowing – Accepts knowledge from authority
2. Transitional/Independent Knowing – Recognizes multiple viewpoints
3. Contextual Knowing – Evaluates knowledge based on evidence and context.

[B.Ed. \(1.5 Years\)](#)

[BS English](#)

[Files](#)